

3RD HARSH-ENVIRONMENT MASS SPECTROMETRY WORKSHOP

Real Time Volcanic Gas Monitoring Station using In-Situ Mass Spectrometry at Irazu Volcano

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ABSTRACT

Following the research on volcanic monitoring using field-portable mass spectrometers presented last year's at the HEMS 2001 workshop , we describe the operation of the first real time MS based gas monitoring station in Costa Rica. The station is located at Irazu volcano and is the first step of an attempt to establish a network of mass spectrometers designed to provide reliable and continuous information on the gas geochemistry of the volcanoes and its role to forecast volcanic eruptions . The systems used are described together with the first data collected.